

the php program. Now, this is the most annoying part. The configure script does not report all errors in one go but stops at the first one. If you resolve the first one and then find another, it becomes much difficult.

A bigger problem comes when you are trying to install a dependency (in this case libxml2-dev) and you find that it too needs some other package. Now, think of the situation when you have multiple dependencies (say 7) and each dependency further relies on 4 other dependencies. SO there are in total of 28 dependencies which you need to install, one after another. Since, we are talking about installing software on a machine with no Internet connection, and it is possible that you might be using the nearest cyber cafe or a friend's computer to download packages (searching the right version is another problem rooted within this all), it will easily drive you mad. However, for sake of simplicity, let us consider for the time being that we have to deal with only one single dependency – libxml2-dev and that we have installed it.

Now run the command again and you should have a long output and the end of it should say “Thank you for using PHP.”

This indicates that the PHP package is ready to be installed.

- At this point of time, it has been verified that PHP can be installed on the system if the actual source code has no errors (and it should not have any because the package was most probably tested by the developers). The only job the configure script does is to check whether the system satisfies the requirements and create other files called ‘makefiles’. A makefile is once again a type of configuration file. It contains instructions for the compiler to follow, basically telling it what all has to be considered while compiling. Now we have to actually compile the package. So call the program ‘make’ by typing the same at a command line. This will call the compiler for every file individually and compile the whole package.

Make should produce a lot of output and then get ready with the command line once again. Do notice the last few lines though. If they mention that there was an error then you should ask the community for help (make errors depend on the project source and only the project developers can help). If make did not report an error, its time to finally install the package. Just say ‘sudo make install’ at the command line.

The reason we use ‘sudo’ is that a software installation might need to copy some files to the directories which are available to the root user only. Using ‘sudo’ will elevate the privileges and make sure that the files get copied to the location they should.